DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL JANKIPURAM, LUCKNOW

SESSION 2025-2026 PERIODIC ASSESSMENT 1

SUBJECT- ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (184)

SET 1

Time: 1 ½ Hrs.

M.M.: 40

Date:_____ Name :_____ Class / Sec. X_____

General Instruction

- This paper is divided into three parts: A, B and C. All questions are compulsory.
- Separate instructions are given with each section and question, wherever necessary. Read these instructions very carefully and follow them.
- Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.

Section A: Reading Skills

I. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow. (8)

(1) Water is one of the most essential resources on Earth, yet it is often taken for granted. Despite its abundance, the reality is that only a small fraction of the world's water is fresh and available for human use. With increasing populations, climate change, and industrial demands, the pressure on our water resources is growing. This makes water conservation not just a collective responsibility but a crucial individual duty. Each person's effort towards conserving water can significantly impact the preservation of this vital resource for future generations.

(2) One of the primary reasons individual water conservation efforts are so important is the cumulative effect of small actions which may seem trivial on their own. However, when multiplied by millions of people, these actions can lead to substantial water savings. For example, a single dripping tap can waste over 15 litres of water a day. Imagine the water saved if every household in a city repaired just one leaky faucet. This highlights the power of collective individual actions in reducing water waste.

(3) Moreover, personal efforts towards water conservation often lead to greater awareness and education. When individuals take steps to conserve water, they become more conscious of their water usage and the importance of this resource. This awareness can then spread within communities, inspiring others to adopt similar practices. For instance, a family that installs water-saving devices in their home may encourage neighbours and friends to do the same, creating a ripple effect. This grassroots approach to conservation can be particularly effective in areas where larger-scale initiatives may be slow to implement or lacking in support.

(4) In addition to daily habits, individuals can also make a difference through more significant lifestyle choices. For instance, opting for drought-resistant plants in gardens and supporting water-efficient agriculture can all contribute to water conservation. Agriculture, especially livestock farming, is one of the largest consumers of water globally. By supporting sustainable farming practices, individuals can indirectly reduce the water footprint of their food.

(5) Critics might argue that individual efforts are negligible compared to the large-scale water consumption by industries and agriculture. However, this perspective overlooks the potential for individual actions to drive systemic change. When people collectively make water-conscious choices, they send a powerful message to businesses and policymakers about the importance of conservation.

(6) Each person's commitment to saving water, no matter how small, contributes to a larger culture of sustainability. By making conscious choices and spreading awareness, individuals can help ensure that future generations have access to the clean, fresh water they need to thrive. Water conservation is not just the responsibility of governments and industries; it is a shared duty that begins with each of us.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage (8 X 1= 8)

1. In paragraph 1, what does the phrase 'each person's effort towards conserving water can significantly impact the preservation of this vital resource' emphasise?
2. Complete the following with the correct option from the two given.

Water is often taken for granted, despite its essential nature because _____

(a) it is abundant and always easily accessible, making people less aware of its usage

(b) its importance is not always recognised, leading people to overlook its value.

3. State whether the following statement is True or False. (paragraph 3)

Large-scale initiatives take longer time to implement, so the writer recommends grass root efforts.

4. *The writer mentions 'sustainable farming practices' in paragraph 4.*

Which of the following is a sustainable farming practice?

A. Using chemical fertilizers and pesticides extensively to increase crop yields.
B. Clearing large areas of natural vegetation to expand farmland for organic farming.
C. Implementing crop rotation and using organic compost to maintain soil health.
D. Relying solely on monoculture farming to maximise production efficiency.

5. List any one point that a powerful message sent to businesses and policy makers of water conservation might include. (paragraph 5)

6. Fill in the blank with the correct option from those given.

In the phrase "culture of sustainability, the word 'culture' refers to _____.
A. A set of beliefs and practices shared by a group.
B. The artistic and traditional practices specific to a community's heritage.
C. The lifestyle habits and choices that are popular among the urbane.
D. The techniques and methods used in development efforts

7. Explain the concept of a 'ripple effect in the context of student life at school. (paragraph 3)

8. List one of the primary reasons for the importance of individual water conservation. (para 2)

Section B: Writing Skills and Grammar

II. Complete any five of the six tasks, as directed. (5 X 1 = 5)

1. Read the given sentence from a marketing report. Identify the error and supply the correction in the given format.

The company continues to strives tirelessly to meet customer demands.

Error	Correction

2. Complete the following school announcement by selecting the correct option to fill in the blank.

Our school's robotics team has successfully _____ a place in the semi- finals.

a. securing b. secured c. will secure d. had secured

3. Detect the error and supply the correction for the given observation by a child.

That needn't be dad's jacket. It's too small.

Error	Correction

4. Fill in the blank.

Dear Mr. Patel

We are pleased to inform you that your proposal for the upcoming project _____ by the board of directors.

a. had endorsed c. will have been endorsed
b. has been endorsed d. have endorsed

5. Select the correct option to complete the given sentence from a handbook for managers.
The manager _____ consider the proposal before making a decision.
a. will b. should c. might d. can

6. Complete the given sentence about the reaction of some friends, by selecting the correct option.
The group of friends _____ excited at the prospect of their upcoming adventure.
a. are b. has c. is d. were

III. You are Nirmal Singh, a concerned citizen from New Delhi. Compose a letter in about 100- 120 words, to the Editor of a national daily, highlighting the adverse effects of e- waste* pollution. Suggest measures for addressing its management through community engagement and government initiatives.
(*Discarded electronic devices such as smartphones, computers and televisions which are no longer in use or have reached the end of their shelf life.) **(1 X 5 = 5)**

OR

You are Ujjval/ Ujjvala Pathak of New Delhi. Write a letter in about 100- 120 words addressing the Editor of a newspaper, throwing light on the problem of overgrown trees and shrubs in the city, raising awareness about the problems caused by them and requesting the respective authorities for regular pruning through the columns of the newspaper.

Section C: Literature

IV. Reference to context. Attempt any ONE (3 X 1 = 3)

A. But the decades of oppression and brutality had another unintended effect, and that was that it produced the Oliver Tambos, the Walter Sisulus, the Chief Luthilis, and the Yusuf Dadoos, the Bram Fischers, and the Robert Sobukwes of our times- men of such extraordinary courage, wisdom and generosity that their like may never be known again. Perhaps it requires such depths of oppression to create such heights of character. My country is rich in minerals and gems that beneath its soil, but I have always known that its greatest wealth is its people, finer and truer than the purest diamonds.

1. What was the unintended effect of the long oppression?
i. It made the people indifferent to injustice.
ii. It made the people reject oppression.
iii. It influenced a generation to fight.
iv. It made people accept their oppression.
2. Fill in the blank with one word only.
Nelson Mandela compares _____ to diamonds.
3. To whom does 'men of such extraordinary courage' refer?

OR

B. Some say the world will end in fire
Some say in ice.
From what I've tasted of desire
I hold with those who favour fire.

1. What does 'fire' stand for in the given extract?
2. These lines from the poem tell us that_
i. people should be carefree.
ii. people should be fearless.
iii. people should know the consequences of desire.
iv. the poet has been a victim of hatred.
3. What is the rhyme scheme of the extract?

V. Reference to context. Attempt any ONE (3 X 1 = 3)

A. The expected call came within a few days. Mrs Pumphrey was distraught. Tricki would eat nothing. Refused even his favourite dishes; and besides he had bouts of vomiting.

1. Why did the speaker expect a call?
2. Mrs Pumphrey was distraught because-

i. Tricki had been troubling her with his regular tantrums.
ii. she could not take Tricki for his regular walks.
iii. Tricki had started eating too much lately.
iv. Tricki had fallen sick.

3. Find a word from the extract which means the same as 'extremely worried'.

OR

B. When the train had gone, I found myself standing on the deserted platform. I had no idea where to spend the night. I had no friends, believing that friends were more trouble than help.

1. Who is the speaker of the above lines?
2. Why did the speaker not board the train?

i. He had no ticket.
ii. He did not know where to go.
iii. He feared that cops would catch him.
iv. He feared losing his friend's trust

3. Find a word from the above extract which means the same as 'isolated'

VI. Answer the following in brief. (30 to 40 words) (4 X 2 = 8)

1. How do you know that Anne loved her 'Grandma' very much?
2. What happened when the narrator flew the aeroplane into the stormy clouds?

OR

Why does the poet not want to intrude on the little boy? What does he suggest in the poem 'The Ball Poem'?

3. Why did Hari Singh feel the necessity of going back to Anil in the chapter 'The Thief's Story'?
4. What realisation dawned upon Mr. Herriot when he saw the fat dog?

VII. Answer the following in detail. (100- 120 words) (2 X 4 = 8)

1. To identify wild animals, Carolyn Wells, the poetess humorously suggest some dangerous ways. Explain with reference to the poem 'How to Tell Wild Animals'.

OR

Both 'Dust of Snow' and 'A Letter to God' use contrasting elements of human nature to convey their respective messages about life and human behaviour, but they do it differently. Examine these differences.

2. How is the title of the chapter 'A Triumph of Surgery' aptly justified by the character of Mr. Herriot?

OR

'Love and affection can transform even a criminal.' Explain how it is true in the case of Hari Singh with reference to the chapter 'A Thief's Story'.